



THE MORNING KICKOFF

📍 FIFA World Cup 26 — United States · Canada · Mexico · Semi-final 1 tonight: France–Spain in Dallas, 21:00 CET

📅 Tonight, on Bastille Day: France–Spain for a place in the final — 21:00 our time

★ The Crystal Ball is back — tonight's call is France 2–1, full workings on page 3

⚡ Kalshi this morning: \$1.56m traded — France 42, Tie 30, Spain 30

⚡ SEMI-FINAL 1 · TONIGHT · 21:00 · DALLAS

THE WAVE MEETS THE WALL.

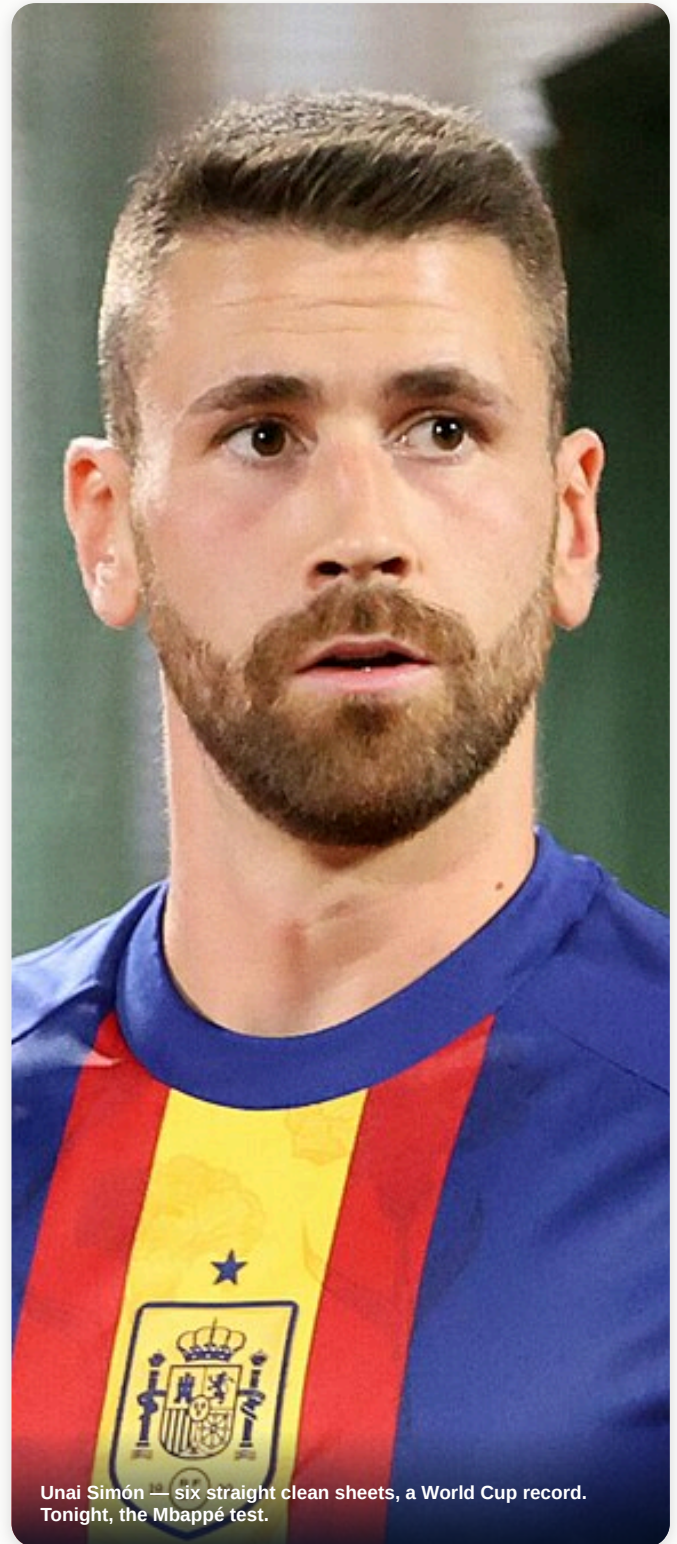
Bastille Day, and France bring the tournament's most relentless attack — 18 goals, Mbappé and Dembélé accounting for 13 — into collision with the meanest defence in World Cup history. Unai Simón kept six consecutive clean sheets, a record no side had ever managed. One of football's two best teams goes home tonight; the other gets Sunday at MetLife.

ALSO THIS MORNING

- ⚡ France are whole again: L'Équipe reports Tchouaméni returns to the XI after missing two matches with a groin problem, and Mbappé — "completely fine" — starts.
- ⚽ Spain report a clean bill of health and field their strongest side. The back catalogue favours them: winners of the Euro 2024 semi and the 5–4 Nations League epic.
- 📅 Tomorrow it's England–Argentina in Atlanta, also 21:00 — the market can barely split them at 37–32. The Crystal Ball record stands at 5 from 7, two exact scores.

INSIDE TODAY'S EDITION

- P.2 Tonight previewed in full — plus tomorrow's England–Argentina and the back catalogue
- P.3 The Crystal Ball: France 2–1 — the probabilities, the factors, the live market
- P.4 Golden Boot: Mbappé and Dembélé can move tonight; Messi answers Wednesday
- P.5 The road to the final: bracket, third place Saturday, the final Sunday



Unai Simón — six straight clean sheets, a World Cup record. Tonight, the Mbappé test.

THE SEMIS (CENTRAL EUROPE)



France
–
Spain



21:00



England –
Argentina



Wed
21:00

FULL PREVIEWS
PAGE 2



THE MORNING
KICKOFF

Tuesday 14 July 2026 · Edition #9 · Team news & previews: FIFA, Sports Mole, RotoWire, Goal, SI, Yahoo Sports, L'Équipe (via reports) — checked morning of 14 July 2026. Market prices: Kalshi, morning of 14 July. Kick-off times in Central European Time unless flagged otherwise.

1 /
5

SF1 • TONIGHT • BASTILLE DAY • DALLAS



France

VS

Spain






21:00



22:00



00:30 +1



15:00



13:00

Kick-off 3:00 PM ET at the stadium

AT&T Stadium, Dallas

France arrive perfect — six wins, one goal conceded, and now whole again with Tchouaméni back in the pivot and Mbappé cleared. Spain arrive as the record wall: six straight clean sheets before Belgium finally scored on Friday, and every knockout round survived by a single goal. History says Spain — they won the Euro 2024 semi and the 5–4 Nations League classic. The money says France, 42 to 30. Something gives tonight.

- Mbappé against Simón — 8 goals versus the record streak; nobody has beaten him twice this tournament
- Yamal, France's tormentor at 16, now the World Cup version at 18
- Tchouaméni's return — the shield that lets Olise and Doué create without fear



KEY MAN • FRANCE

Kylian Mbappé

Eight goals, an ankle scare shrugged off, and a Bastille Day stage. Spain's wall is the last thing between him and a third World Cup final at 27.

SF2 • TOMORROW • ATLANTA



England

VS

Argentina





Wed 21:00

Kick-off 3:00 PM ET at the stadium

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

Twenty-four hours later, the heavyweight rematch of rematches: Hand of God, Beckham's red, Beckham's penalty — now for a place in a World Cup final. Both squads are healthy, both endured 120 minutes on Saturday, and the market still can't pick a side: England 37, the tie 34, Argentina 32. The Crystal Ball takes its swing tomorrow morning.

- Bellingham against Messi — four knockout goals versus the man chasing back-to-back titles
- Kane on 5: three goals in two games would steal the Golden Boot from the men on 8
- The recovery race — whoever's legs come back first from Saturday's extra time wins the last half-hour



KEY MAN • ENGLAND

Jude Bellingham

Four goals, all in knockout games England were losing or drawing. Against Argentina's midfield he isn't the future of this fixture — he's the present.

FRANCE–SPAIN: THE BACK CATALOGUE

Two decades of heavyweight meetings



Spain

2 – 1

France



Euro 2024 semi • Yamal, Olmo



Spain

5 – 4

France



Nations League 2025 semi



Spain

1 – 2

France



2021 UNL final • Mbappé

France



3 – 1

Spain



World Cup 2006 • Zidane's run

TOMORROW: SF2 — ENGLAND–ARGENTINA, ATLANTA, 21:00 CET. MARKET: ENGLAND 37, TIE 34, ARGENTINA 32

France v Spain

★ OUR CALL: FRANCE 2-1

RESULT AFTER 90 MINUTES



TO REACH THE FINAL



⚡ LIVE MARKET · KALSHI · REGULATION-TIME MONEYLINE · \$1.56M

France 42% 42% Tie 30% 30% Spain 30% 30%

FORM

France are six from six with one goal conceded. Spain are unbeaten with a record six straight clean sheets — but every Spanish knockout win has been by a single goal.

HEAD-TO-HEAD

Spain won the two that hurt most: the Euro 2024 semi (2–1) and the 2025 Nations League semi (5–4). France's last win over them was the 2021 Nations League final.

FITNESS & FATIGUE

Advantage France: Mbappé is "completely fine", Tchouaméni returns per L'Équipe, and France had the extra day of rest — they played Thursday, Spain Friday.

WHERE THE MONEY IS

Kalshi's \$1.56m — the tournament's biggest match market yet — splits France 42, Tie 30, Spain 30. A third of the money expects ninety minutes to not be enough.

⚡ THE VERDICT The wall cracks — once more than the wave does. Olise finds Mbappé one time too many and France shade it 2–1 in ninety. But if it goes to extra time, everything the last two years have taught us says Spain.

The Crystal Ball is for family bragging rights only. Probabilities blend live prediction-market prices with our own reading of form, fitness and history. Entertainment — not financial or betting advice. Record so far: 5 winners from 7, two exact scorelines.



8

Lionel Messi

Watches tonight, plays tomorrow — two games from the Double



8

Kylian Mbappé

Plays tonight — one goal against the record wall takes the lead



7

Erling Haaland

Eliminated — his race ends one goal short

1	Lionel Messi Argentina · plays Wed		8
2	Kylian Mbappé France · plays tonight		8
3	Erling Haaland Norway · eliminated		7
4	Harry Kane England · plays Wed		5
5	Ousmane Dembélé France · plays tonight		5
6	Jude Bellingham England · plays Wed		4
7	Mikel Oyarzabal Spain · plays tonight		4

Tie-break: assists, then minutes played. Mbappé holds the edge on assists — one goal tonight puts the Boot in his hands.

NUMBERS OF THE DAY

13

Goals for Mbappé and Dembélé combined — France's two-man storm

\$1.6m

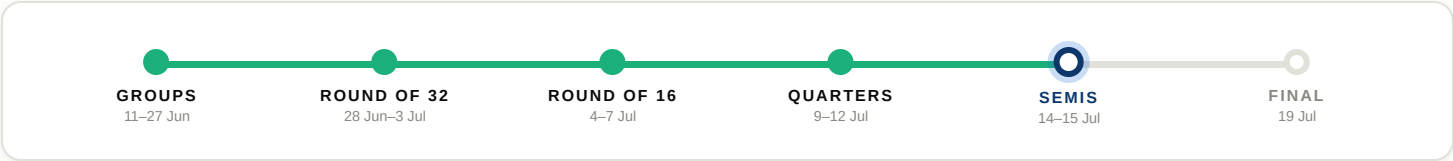
Traded on tonight's game on Kalshi by this morning — the tournament's biggest market yet

2

Times Spain have knocked France out in the last two years — tonight is the rematch of the rematch

2

Matches Tchouaméni missed with a groin problem — L'Équipe says he returns tonight



KNOCKOUT BRACKET

Quarter-finals 9-12 July · Semi-finals 14-15 July

QUARTER-FINALS

QF1 · FT · France won 2-0 · · Boston

France

Morocco

QF2 · FT · Spain won 2-1 · · Los Angeles

Spain

Belgium

QF3 · FT · England won 2-1 aet · · Miami

Norway

England

QF4 · FT · Argentina won 3-1 aet · · Kansas City

Argentina

Switzerland

SEMI-FINALS

TONIGHT · 21:00 · Dallas

France vs Spain

Wed 15 July · 21:00 · Atlanta

England vs Argentina

THE FINAL

Sunday 19 July

MetLife Stadium, New York / New Jersey

YOUR WEEK IN FOOTBALL

Tuesday 14 July — the final on Sunday 19 July

TUE
14 Jul

SF1 France-Spain
· 21:00

WED
15 Jul

SF2 England-Argentina · 21:00

THU
16 Jul

Rest day

FRI
17 Jul

Rest day

SAT
18 Jul

Third place · Miami
· 23:00

SUN
19 Jul

THE FINAL · MetLife

MON
20 Jul

The wrap-up special

See you tomorrow morning.

Next edition: the France-Spain verdict, the England-Argentina Crystal Ball, and two nights from the trophy.